Eric Ariel De La Paz

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ABOUT ME

Junior Product Designer | Design Systems, Interaction Design & Advanced Prototyping
Product design intern across two concurrent internships, building token-based Figma design systems, high-fidelity interactive prototypes, and engineering handoff for web, mobile, and desktop products. Ships working software with AI tools (Claude, Gemini, GitHub Copilot), directing each iteration and reviewing it against user needs. B.S. in User Experience Design, Western Governors University (expected Nov 2026).

EDUCATION

Western Governors University

Bachelor's degree in User Experience Design *Expected Nov 2026*

- Coursework: user-centered design, information architecture, wireframing, prototyping, accessibility, usability testing, and research methods (interviews, surveys, A/B testing), plus marketing and project management.

Coursera

Google UX Design Professional Certificate *Expected Nov 2026*

EXPERIENCE

UI/UX Design Intern **Jul 2026 – Present**

Flyrank AI *Remote*

• Built a Figma token-based design system (variables, 4-color semantic palette, typographic scale) with every style linked to shared tokens, cutting visual rework by an estimated ~60% by keeping screens consistent, and making global UI updates an estimated ~90% faster because one token change updates every linked component.
• Ran competitive audits across 10+ sources, paired with desk research (customer reviews, return-rate data, style guides), to design a specialist fit-confirmation checkpoint for men's luxury formalwear rental, addressing recurring fit-uncertainty complaints.
• Designed multi-state UI patterns in Figma using components and variants (dropdowns, bottom sheets, tabbed selectors, collapsible navigation) and documented interaction behavior for engineering handoff.
• Cut the UI element count by over half under time constraints by consolidating redundant components and styles, tying each removal to user goals and core flows.
• Developed a 7-section information architecture and three annotated user flows (primary task, onboarding, recovery with escalation).

Product Design Intern **Jul 2026 – Present**

Stealth Startup *Remote*

• Led creation of a Figma token-based design system from scratch for a product that had none, applied across two mobile apps and a desktop dashboard, as one of ~5 design interns reporting to the founder.

- **Built high-fidelity interactive prototypes with complex component states, dynamic overlays, typeable form fields, and conditional logic for engineering handoff, cutting demo setup and run time by 30+ minutes per demo, timed against the previous demo process.**
- **Delivered ~30 new and refined screens plus multiple overlays, working with the founder, an engineer, and ~5 interns.**
- **Mentored 2–3 design interns per session, reviewed their work, and led monthly workshops on responsive design and advanced Figma prototyping, including Figma variables in interactive prototypes.**
- **Role performed under NDA; scope and outcomes are accurate, and company details are confidential.**

PROJECTS

Full Case Studies: https://ericarieldelapaz.tech

- **Study Buddy (self-initiated, AI-assisted):** Designed a desktop focus companion in Figma (mascot, break overlays, reminders, app rules, light and dark themes) and built it in Electron, React, and TypeScript by directing Gemini and Gemini 4 Argon through staged change lists, reviewing every round against my designs. About 14 hours of active build time across 40+ commits (counted from commit timestamps), shipping Windows, macOS, and Linux installers, in-app nudges for listed apps and sites, and a notepad. User testing with students planned.
- **SecureID (self-initiated case study):** Identity-verification flow and analyst dashboard on one shared token system; cut the analyst screen to three primary actions (Reject, Escalate, Approve) with overlays.
- **Vextaro (Flyrank AI internship):** Men's luxury formalwear rental app with a specialist fit-confirmation checkpoint, 7-section information architecture, and token-based design system.
- **Devtective (Google UX Certificate capstone):** Gamified coding-habit app concept with personas, journey maps, design system, and high-fidelity screens, built around re-entry after a gap.
- **Honda of Clear Lake (heuristic audit):** Evaluated a dealership website against Nielsen's 10 heuristics, rating every finding on a 0–4 severity scale.

SKILLS

Design: Product Design, UX/UI Design, Interaction Design, Visual Design, Visual Hierarchy, Typography, Style Guides, Responsive Design, Mobile-First Design, Accessibility (WCAG)

Research & Process: User Experience Research, Qualitative Research, Quantitative Research, Competitive Analysis, Research Synthesis, User Journey Mapping, Personas, Usability Testing, Design Thinking, Information Architecture, User Flows, Wireframing, Prototyping

Systems & Handoff: Design Systems, Design Tokens & Variables, Components & Libraries, Engineering Handoff, HTML, CSS

Tools: Figma, FigJam, GitHub, Microsoft Office, Google Workspace, Granola AI, Claude, Gemini, GitHub Copilot, Grammarly

Soft: Cross-Functional Collaboration, Communication, Design Critiques, Empathy, Problem-Solving, Adaptability and Resilience, Critical Thinking and Decision-Making